

CULLUM'S COLUMN by Dick Cullum



Small Shortstop But a Big Man

THE FIRST THREE YEARS DONIE BUSH managed the Minneapolis Millers his teams finished first.

Small wonder he is in town as guest of honor of the Baseball Boosters' banquet Thursday night at the Radisson.

Bush is remembered in major league history as the game's smallest shortstop.

Despite his lack of inches he played 14 years at Detroit, all but the first year as a regular.

During much of the time he had for teammates such great ones as Ty Cobb, Bob Veach, Sam Crawford, Charley O'Leary and Wild Bill Donovan.

Donie finished his playing career at Washington and later managed Washington, Pittsburgh, the Chicago White Sox and Cincinnati.



Bush

HE WAS A WINNER

IN HIS SIX YEARS of service here Donie led the league three times, finished third once and sixth twice.

The combination of Mike Kelley in the office making the deals and Bush on the field giving the right signs was hard to beat.

"Mike was a great one," said Donie. "He never interfered with me, and he was so wonderful with the players that we always had a happy, hustling team. Nobody knew ball players the way Mike did."

"Remember those animals Mike used to have around?"

THIS AMUSED MIKE

AND THAT RECALLS A STORY Mike used to tell. "I had a Dalmatian dog," he said, "and a mean parrot. Donie hated them both and they both hated Donie. One day Donie came to the office after a tough game. My hands were scratched and bleeding from playing with the parrot. Donie didn't like that. 'Why don't you get rid of that crow?' he asked. Just then the Dalmatian wondered in. 'And get rid of that spotted wolf, too,' Donie shouted. He left in a rage, slammed the door so hard all the pictures fell off the wall; and he never came into the office again."

THERE WAS POWER

DONIE RECALLED HIS pennant-winning team at Minneapolis.

"There was smartness and power," he said. "Remember Spencer Harris, Joe Mowry, Babe Ganzel, Andy Cohen, Joe Hauser, Buzz Arlett, Red Hargraves, Ernie Smith and Wes Griffin?"



Cohen

"Cohen was a fine field general. He made the plays. Harris was a smart one, too. Spencer could figure pitchers. He knew what they were trying to do to him and he'd outsmart them. He also was a good one at stealing signs. Any time after he'd got to second base he'd come in and ask, 'Want the signs, Donie? I've got them,' and he'd have 'em, too."

RED SOX THE BEST

DONIE ASKS US TO PUT it in print that Minneapolis is now a part of baseball's finest organization.

"The Red Sox are the best," he said. "They keep their word to the letter. They respect their fans and spend what it takes to give them what they want."

"They go first class. They are a happy, hustling organization and they will have the Millers in there contending all the time."

"You know," Donie added, "I've had some of these boys with me. Joe Cronin played for me when I managed Pittsburgh. Tommy Thomas pitched for me when I managed the White Sox and Charley Wagner (assistant farm director) was with me in Minneapolis. These are all class people."

TED TALKED BACK

DONIE HAS VIVID RECOLLECTIONS of the then 19-year-old, impetuous Ted Williams who paused here for a year on his way to Boston.

"One day," said Donie, "Ted hit a double. You remember how he used to act on the baseline, loose jointed and wool gathering. We needed that run and Ted was out there slouching around and paying no attention to my shouts. At last I couldn't stand it any longer. I called time and went out to second base."

"I said, 'Look, Williams, this is a ball game. You better get into the game or these guys will pick you off, and we need you.'"

"Ted said, 'Listen, Bush, I got this far by myself and I can take care of myself the rest of the way.'"

"Come to think of it," Donie added, "He HAS taken care of himself the rest of the way, hasn't he?"